

CRIME INVESTIGATION - EVIDENCE REPORT

Case Reference: HBL-2026-KD-0074

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Date: Evidence Logged: 22 August 2026

1. Physical Evidence

Item E-001: Victim's spectacles and a shoe recovered in the warehouse parking. Item E-002: Tempo Traveller (KA-25-C-3318) found abandoned at Kalghatgi, reported stolen from Hubballi railway station on 15 August; partial fingerprints lifted from the sliding door and steering wheel. Item E-003: Rope, duct tape and a blindfold cloth recovered from the farmhouse where the victim was held. Item E-004: Cash counting notes indicating the ransom was counted at the farmhouse.

2. CCTV and Digital Evidence

The warehouse camera was switched off at 7:05 PM using its local controller. A neighbouring shop camera shows a grey Tempo Traveller arriving at 7:50 PM and leaving at 8:15 PM. Ransom calls were made from three different SIMs, all activated a week before the kidnapping. Tower data places the callers near Kalghatgi. A constable's phone number appears in call logs with a gang member twice on the day of the kidnapping.

3. Witness Statements

Ashok Bhat (Warehouse guard): Says he left his post for tea for 30 minutes at the critical time, at the request of a caller he believed was the supervisor. Latha Hiremath (PA): Says she circulated the daily schedule as usual to office staff and several outside contacts. Ransom drop witness: Saw a young man on a motorcycle collect the bag at Dharwad who resembled the accountant's nephew.

4. Financial Evidence

Rs. 7 lakh of the ransom money was deposited into an account belonging to Ganesh Shinde's cousin. The dismissed accountant Sanjay Patil paid Rs. 1.5 lakh to the farmhouse owner Shivanand as advance rent three weeks before the kidnapping.